

1.1 RATIONALE

This specification is consistent with the GCSE Criteria for Business Studies and Economics (QCA 2000).

The overall aim of this specification is to enable centres to develop a course which will encourage candidates to:

- think from an economic perspective;
- understand basic economic concepts and theories;
- apply these concepts and theories to a range of economic contexts;
- explain and evaluate the market economy and the economic role of government;
- explain and evaluate the influence of the European Union on UK economic activity.

The specification is also intended to provide candidates with:

- a knowledge of both micro-economics and macro-economics;
- the ability to understand a range of current economic issues and to study relevant data from local, national, European and international sources;
- the ability to look critically at the basic economic models relating to issues such as demand and supply analysis, the role of government and the influence of international factors.

The specification will provide a qualification which will be:

- an appropriate foundation for a GCE Advanced Subsidiary or GCE Advanced qualification in Economics, or related subjects;
- an appropriate entry qualification for a range of other courses available at the end of compulsory education;
- an appropriate entry qualification for employment and/or training at the end of compulsory education.

The specification assumes no previous knowledge or study of Economics.

OCR has taken great care in the preparation of this specification and assessment material to avoid bias of any kind.